

# Multi Cat Aggression Fix Guide — Action Checklist

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## ASSESS AGGRESSION TYPE

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- ☐ **Identify when the aggression started by checking whether it was sudden or gradual to determine if you need emergency veterinary care first.:** Identify when the aggression started by checking whether it was sudden or gradual to determine if you need emergency veterinary care first.
- ☐ **Observe where the aggression happens most frequently and note if attacks occur near litter boxes, food bowls, windows, or random locations to identify trigger patterns.:** Observe where the aggression happens most frequently and note if attacks occur near litter boxes, food bowls, windows, or random locations to identify trigger patterns.
- ☐ **Watch the attacking cat's body language closely and compare their posture against territorial stalking, fear-based crouching, or predatory hunting behaviors to classify the aggression type.:** Watch the attacking cat's body language closely and compare their posture against territorial stalking, fear-based crouching, or predatory hunting behaviors to classify the aggression type.
- ☐ **Track whether the aggression is getting worse, staying stable, or slowly improving over time so you can tell if your interventions are actually working.:** Track whether the aggression is getting worse, staying stable, or slowly improving over time so you can tell if your interventions are actually working.

## RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

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- ☐ **Schedule a veterinary exam immediately if aggression started suddenly or if a previously calm cat became aggressive without any clear environmental trigger.:** Schedule a veterinary exam immediately if aggression started suddenly or if a previously calm cat became aggressive without any clear environmental trigger.
- ☐ **Request a full physical exam including bloodwork, urinalysis, and dental evaluation from your veterinarian and explicitly ask them to rule out pain as a cause.:** Request a full physical exam including bloodwork, urinalysis, and dental evaluation from your veterinarian and explicitly ask them to rule out pain as a cause.

- ☐ **Set up your home with multiple litter boxes, food stations, and vertical spaces like cat trees so your cats have fewer resources to compete over and claim as personal territory.:** Set up your home with multiple litter boxes, food stations, and vertical spaces like cat trees so your cats have fewer resources to compete over and claim as personal territory.
- ☐ **Complete a full scent exchange by swapping bedding and blankets between your cats for at least one week before attempting any visual contact or face-to-face meetings.:** Complete a full scent exchange by swapping bedding and blankets between your cats for at least one week before attempting any visual contact or face-to-face meetings.

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## EXECUTE THE RE-INTRODUCTION

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- ☐ **Follow the complete 3-to-6-week re-introduction protocol from separation through visual introduction rather than letting your cats work out aggression on their own unsupervised.:** Follow the complete 3-to-6-week re-introduction protocol from separation through visual introduction rather than letting your cats work out aggression on their own unsupervised.
- ☐ **Use site swapping to give each cat solo time in the shared spaces while the other remains confined, helping them build positive associations with areas where conflicts occurred.:** Use site swapping to give each cat solo time in the shared spaces while the other remains confined, helping them build positive associations with areas where conflicts occurred.
- ☐ **Add environmental enrichment like puzzle feeders, interactive toys, and window perches to reduce stress and give aggressive cats an outlet for their hunting instincts.:** Add environmental enrichment like puzzle feeders, interactive toys, and window perches to reduce stress and give aggressive cats an outlet for their hunting instincts.
- ☐ **Accept that your cats may never become best friends and focus on helping them achieve peaceful coexistence through managed resources and supervised positive interactions.:** Accept that your cats may never become best friends and focus on helping them achieve peaceful coexistence through managed resources and supervised positive interactions.